

IELTS Writing Task 2 Guide

Structure · useful phrases · checklist

The four-paragraph structure

Paragraph	What to write	Sentences
Introduction	Paraphrase the question + your clear position	2
Body 1	Main idea 1 → explanation → example	4–5
Body 2	Main idea 2 (or other view) → explanation → example	4–5
Conclusion	Restate your position in new words	1–2

Useful phrases

Purpose	Phrases
Giving opinion	I strongly believe that... / In my view...
Adding ideas	Furthermore, ... / In addition, ... / Moreover, ...
Contrasting	However, ... / On the other hand, ... / Although...
Examples	For instance, ... / A clear example of this is...
Results	As a result, ... / Consequently, ... / This leads to...
Concluding	In conclusion, ... / To sum up, ...

Before you submit — checklist

- Did I answer **every part** of the question?
- Is my opinion clear in the introduction and conclusion?
- Does each body paragraph have one main idea and an example?
- Did I write at least **250 words**?
- Did I check articles (a/the), subject-verb agreement and spelling?

Practice question

Some people think children should start school at a very young age, while others believe they should begin at 7 or older. Discuss both views and give your own opinion. (40 minutes, 250+ words)